

ters that can be used when you're trying to integrate 3D models into the scene.

Turning Movies Into 3D Objects

Wax lets you map movies on to basic 3D objects like spheres and cubes using the Objects 3D plugin, and then treat it as any other 3D object. A perfect example is a map of the earth—you could load it into the movie, apply the Objects 3D plugin, select Sphere, and then animate its rotation!

More 3D Effects

Another thing of interest is the Vortex effect, which creates a tornado-like vortex out of the movie you give it. Like all the other 3D effects, even applying a vortex gives you the Transform 3D option to manipulate the object. To animate the vortex, animate the Bend and Bend Rotate parameters to make the tail dance around a bit.

7.4 Particles

From fire and smoke to flying seagulls—it's all possible with particle systems. To get to grips with the basics, we'll create a bunch of floating bubbles using Wax's particle systems.

To begin with, load bubble2.png from Wax's samples folder, and any background of your choice. Drag the background on to the tracks and the bubble on top of it. From the Video Plugins tab, drag the Particle plugin on to the bubble track, and you'll see a track for both Particles and Transform 3D. If you drag along the timeline now, you'll see that the particle system has defaulted to a simulated fire—we'll be changing that to bubbles now.

Expand the Particles track, and you'll see a checkbox labelled Use Media. You will now see the option to select the media—the default is Parent Media, and you can change this to anything that you've loaded into the media pool. For now, we'll just leave it as Parent Media—the bubble image.